

A DEVELOPMENT HANDBOOK · EIGHTEEN SHEETS, IN ORDER

The Aperture Method

A snowflake grows outward from a seed. An aperture stops down — each stop admits less, and the image gets sharper.

PART I · NINE STOPS FOR A GENERATED SHORT

PART II · THE LONG APERTURE — FEATURE PLANNER & SCRIPT BUILDER

THE VOID ROOM · PRINT DOUBLE-SIDED, WRITE ON IT

Why this is not the Snowflake

The Snowflake Method expands. One sentence becomes a paragraph, becomes a synopsis, becomes a draft — each step growing outward from the one before. That works because prose revises at zero marginal cost. You can rewrite chapter nine forty times and the only price is your afternoon.

Generated film does not behave that way. You cannot revise a shot — you can only re-roll it, paying credits each time, with no guarantee the new roll matches the take you already cut around. The expensive failure mode is not bad writing. It is **drift**: the face that changes between shots, the palette that wanders, the light that comes from nowhere in particular.

So this method inverts the shape. It does not expand — it **narrows**. Each sheet removes freedom, and the sheets are ordered by cost-of-change: whatever is most expensive to fix after generation begins gets locked first. By the time you spend a credit, every decision the model could get wrong has already been made by you.

THE ONE RULE THAT GOVERNS THE WHOLE HANDBOOK

Do not stop down further until the gate at the foot of the current sheet is clear. Every sheet ends in a checklist. Those are not suggestions — they are the mechanism. Skipping one does not save time, it moves the cost to the most expensive possible moment.

HOW TO USE IT

- ☐ Print double-sided. This is a workbook — the blanks are the point.
- ☐ Work the sheets in order. The order is the method; the sheets alone are just forms.
- ☐ One project per copy. Do not reuse a filled sheet for a second film.
- ☐ Part II stands alone — a feature planner and script builder, same philosophy, longer form.
- ☐ Sheets 04, 05 and 06 are the ones that pay for themselves. If you skip anything, do not skip those.

All eighteen sheets, in order

f/1.4	The Ember	THE FEELING
f/2	The Turn	THE STRUCTURE
f/2.8	The Page	THE WHOLE
f/4	The Subject	IDENTITY
f/5.6	The World	THE LOOK
f/8	The Grammar	THE CAMERA
f/11	The Beat Board	THE CLOCK
f/16	The Shot Ledger	THE GENERATION
f/22	The Finish	THE DELIVERY
PART II · THE LONG APERTURE		
L/1	The Spine	THE ARGUMENT
L/2	The Dossier	ONE PER CHARACTER
L/3	The Four Movements	SHAPE
L/4	The Eight Sequences	THE REAL UNIT
L/5	The Scene Ledger	ONE ROW PER SCENE
L/6	The Script Builder	PAGE CRAFT
L/7	The Dialogue Pass	VOICE
L/8	The Revision Passes	IN ORDER
L/9	The Production Bible	HANDOFF

PART I

Nine Stops

*A three-to-five minute generated short.
Wide open at f/1.4, everything still possible.
Stopped down to f/22, nothing left to chance.*

The Ember

Everything downstream is a delivery system for one feeling. Name it before you own a single image, because every later decision is judged against it and nothing else. A film that generates beautifully and lands nothing has failed at this sheet, not at the render.

THE RULE

Write the feeling in the viewer's chest at the last frame — in one sentence, with no plot in it. If your sentence contains a then, it is a plot and you have not done this sheet.

FILL THIS IN

THE EMBER

WHY THIS, WHY YOU

AT A GLANCE

WORKING TITLE

RUNTIME TARGET 3:15 – 4:30

LAST FRAME IS —

ONE-WORD TONE —

WORKED EXAMPLE

Ember: *the ache of being seen clearly by something that cannot speak.*

Not an ember: *“a lighthouse keeper meets a creature and then has to choose.” That is a logline wearing a feeling's coat.*

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ The sentence has no plot verb in it.
- ☐ You can say it aloud without looking down.
- ☐ Someone who has not read the idea repeats it back correctly.

The Turn

A three-to-five minute film supports exactly one reversal. Not two. The turn is the whole architecture: everything before it exists to make it land, everything after it is consequence. Locking it now is what stops the middle from sagging at 2:10, which is where shorts die.

THE RULE

*Name one thing that is true at 0:15 and false at 3:00. That flip is your turn. Place it at **60–70% of runtime** so the consequence has room to breathe.*

FILL THIS IN

TRUE AT 0:15

FALSE AT 3:00

WHAT FLIPS IT

AT A GLANCE

TURN LANDS AT	approx. ____ : ____ (60–70%)
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RULE ESTABLISHED BY	0:15 — no preamble, ever
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ENDING RECONTEXTUALISES	the opening image / the first sound / —
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WORKED EXAMPLE

Lights Out (2:41): true at 0:15 — the light protects her. False at the end — the light was never the boundary. One rule, set in fifteen seconds, escalated three times, then broken. That is the entire film.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ There is exactly one reversal, not two.
- ☐ The rule is legible within the first fifteen seconds.
- ☐ The ending changes the meaning of the opening.

The film, entire, on one page — present tense, third person, no dialogue and no camera directions. This is the last sheet where changing your mind is free. After this, every change costs credits.

THE RULE

Present tense. Behaviour only — what a stranger with the sound off would see. If a beat only works because of a line of dialogue, cut the beat or find the behaviour.

FILL THIS IN

THE PAGE

WORKED EXAMPLE

Write it as she does, then she does, then the world answers. If you find yourself typing “she realises”, stop — realisation is not photographable. Find the action that shows it.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ No dialogue anywhere on the page.
- ☐ No interior states — nothing ‘realises’, ‘feels’, or ‘remembers’.
- ☐ It fits on one page without shrinking the type.

The Subject

The single most expensive thing to fix later. Models do not remember your character between generations — they re-invent it every time. Everything you fail to pin here, you will pay for in re-rolls, or you will accept a face that changes between shots and lose the craft score outright.

THE RULE

*Pin the **invariants**: the handful of features that must survive every shot. Five to eight, no more — a list of thirty invariants is a list of none, because no prompt carries thirty.*

FILL THIS IN

INVARIANTS (5–8, NON-NEGOTIABLE)

DELIBERATELY VARIABLE

AT A GLANCE

REFERENCE SET _____ stills, locked before any motion

SEED / CHARACTER ID _____

SILHOUETTE TEST recognisable in black at 3cm? Y / N

COSTUME CHANGES none / _____ — each one is a new identity to hold

WORKED EXAMPLE

Invariants: scar through the left eyebrow · one shoulder permanently lower · rust-coloured oilskin · hair always wet · never smiles.

Variable: exact hair length, background crowd, cloud cover. Anything on the left list that drifts is a re-roll; anything on the right, you let go.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ Invariants fit in one prompt fragment you can paste unchanged.
- ☐ The silhouette is identifiable with all detail removed.
- ☐ The reference set is locked and stored before a single motion generation.

The World

Palette, light logic and texture, decided once and applied everywhere. Consistency of world is what makes generated footage read as photographed rather than assembled, and it is the cheapest craft score on the board — it costs discipline, not credits.

THE RULE

Choose a **narrow** palette and a single light source logic, then shift it exactly once — at the turn. A palette that changes because the model felt like it reads as an accident. A palette that changes at the turn reads as authorship.

FILL THIS IN

PALETTE — FOUR COLOURS, NAMED

LIGHT LOGIC (SOURCE, DIRECTION, QUALITY)

WHAT SHIFTS AT THE TURN

AT A GLANCE

ERA / PLACE —

WEATHER & TIME OF DAY —

TEXTURE FLOOR grain / halation / lens dirt — pick and keep

FORBIDDEN colours and textures that must never appear

WORKED EXAMPLE

Alike carries its entire plot in saturation — the world drains as the father conforms, and returns in one beat. A cinematographer juror reads that in three seconds and knows a person made a decision.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ The palette is four colours or fewer, written as hex or named pigments.
- ☐ One light source dominates and you can say where it is in every shot.
- ☐ The shift happens once, at the turn, and nowhere else.

The Grammar

What the camera is allowed to do. Generated film drifts toward restless drifting motion because that is what the models reward, and restless motion is the single clearest tell of an unauthored AI reel. Constraint here is what buys you the cinematography vote.

THE RULE

*Write a short list of permissions and one **prohibition** you will not break. The prohibition matters more than the permissions.*

FILL THIS IN

LENS SET AND WHY

CAMERA HEIGHT & DISTANCE RULES

MOVEMENT PERMITTED

THE PROHIBITION

AT A GLANCE

ASPECT RATIO — (verify against contest rules)

FRAME RATE / SHUTTER FEEL —

COVERAGE PATTERN e.g. wide → detail → face, repeated

CAMERA MOVES AT THE TURN the one place motion is allowed to change

WORKED EXAMPLE

Permitted: 35mm, eye height, locked off, one slow push per act. **Prohibited:** no handheld, ever. Then break the lock-off exactly once — at the turn — and the movement means something because nothing else moved.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ The prohibition is written and you have not broken it.
- ☐ Every camera move is motivated by a story beat, not by the model.
- ☐ Lens and height are stated in the shot ledger prompt text itself.

The Beat Board

The film as beats against a runtime budget. This is where you find out the film is four minutes long in your head and seven on paper — while that discovery is still free.

THE RULE

Every beat gets a duration in seconds and a job. A beat with no job is cut. Sum the column. If it exceeds your target, cut beats — do not shorten all of them evenly, which is how films become incomprehensible.

AT A GLANCE

TARGET RUNTIME 3:15 – 4:30

BEATS typically 12–20

TURN BEAT NUMBER —

RUNNING TOTAL _____ sec

WORKED EXAMPLE

Budget the ending generously. The last twenty seconds is where the recontextualisation lands, and it is the part every first-time editor starves.

NOTES, FALSE STARTS, THINGS TO TRY

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ Every beat has a duration and a one-line job.
- ☐ The total is inside the target, with the 3:00 floor cleared by margin.
- ☐ The turn sits at 60–70% of the running total.

Worksheet

Sum the seconds column before you go further. The floor is 3:00 and it is measured on the delivered file, not on your timeline.

The Shot Ledger

One row per shot, and the row is written **before** the credit is spent. This is the sheet that turns a pile of clips into a film, and in a contest that requires published prompts, it is also your submission artefact — it costs nothing extra if you keep it as you go, and it is unrecoverable if you do not.

THE RULE

Never generate a shot that has no row. The row is written first, the credit is spent second. A shot generated on impulse is a shot you cannot reproduce.

AT A GLANCE

CONTINUITY CARRY	what must match the previous shot
KEEP / RE-ROLL RULE	decide the accept threshold before you see the output
RE-ROLL CAP	_____ attempts, then change the shot, not the seed
CREDITS SPENT	_____ / budget _____

WORKED EXAMPLE

The re-roll cap is the discipline that saves the budget. Three attempts and it still will not hold? The shot is wrong, not the seed. Re-design it — usually by hiding the thing that keeps drifting.

NOTES, FALSE STARTS, THINGS TO TRY

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ Every shot has a row, and every row has a prompt you could paste again.
- ☐ Seeds and model names are recorded — you cannot reconstruct these later.
- ☐ Continuity carry is filled for every shot after the first.

Worksheet

Write the row, then spend the credit. Never the other way round — a shot generated on impulse is a shot you cannot reproduce, and in a contest requiring published prompts, cannot submit.

The Finish

Sound, music, compliance and publication. Sound is half of what an audience calls ‘quality’ and it is where generated films most obviously give themselves away, because silence under moving images reads as unfinished.

THE RULE

*Cut picture to sound at least once, not only sound to picture. And run the compliance gate **before** the final render, not after — a disqualified film is worth zero regardless of how good it is.*

FILL THIS IN

SOUND SPINE (WHAT CARRIES THE EMOTION)

MUSIC — SOURCE AND LICENCE

THE ONE SILENCE

AT A GLANCE

MUSIC RIGHTS original / royalty-free — licence held?

WATERMARK present on the delivered file?

RUNTIME MEASURED _____ (floor is 3:00)

PROMPTS PUBLISHED yes / no

PUBLIC POST LIVE yes / no

WORKED EXAMPLE

Place one deliberate silence. An audience does not notice good sound design, but it always notices the moment sound stops — and that is free, which makes it the best value in the whole production.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ Runtime clears the floor with margin, measured on the delivered file.
- ☐ No copyrighted IP, characters, logos, or licensed music anywhere.
- ☐ No political and no religious statement, including in the caption.
- ☐ Watermark present; prompts and generation history published.
- ☐ Someone who has never seen it watched it end to end without touching the scrub bar.

PART II

The Long Aperture

*A feature planner and script builder.
Same philosophy, ninety times the runtime —
which is ninety times the opportunity to drift.*

A feature is long enough to be about something, and long enough to fall apart if it is not. The spine is the argument the film makes — stated as a question in the first act and answered by the last image.

THE RULE

Write the theme as a **question**, never as a moral. “What is a person owed by the family that made them?” generates scenes. “Family is complicated” generates nothing.

FILL THIS IN

THEME, AS A QUESTION

THE FILM'S ANSWER

LOGLINE (ONE SENTENCE, WITH THE IRONY IN IT)

AT A GLANCEGENRE & THE PROMISE IT
MAKES

TARGET RUNTIME

_____ min / _____ pages

COMPARABLE FILMS

WHY NOW

WORKED EXAMPLE

Test: can two intelligent people disagree about the answer? If not, it is not a theme, it is a slogan, and the second act will have nothing to argue about.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ The theme is a question, not a statement.
- ☐ The logline contains an irony or a reversal.
- ☐ The answer is delivered by an image, not by a speech.

The Dossier

Characters generate plot; plot does not generate characters. Fill one of these for every character who changes. Anyone who does not change is a function — that is allowed, but know which is which.

THE RULE

Want is what they chase and can state out loud. **Need** is what the story will give them instead. **The lie** is what they believe that is false. **The ghost** is the wound that made the lie reasonable. The arc is the lie breaking.

FILL THIS IN

WANT (STATED, PURSUED, EXTERNAL)

NEED (UNSTATED, TRUE, INTERNAL)

THE LIE THEY BELIEVE

THE GHOST THAT PLANTED IT

WHAT BREAKS THE LIE, AND ON WHAT PAGE

AT A GLANCE

NAME / AGE / ROLE

—

FIRST APPEARANCE

page ____

CONTRADICTION

the two things they are that should not coexist

SPEECH SIGNATURE

rhythm, vocabulary, what they never say

WORKED EXAMPLE

The antagonist gets this sheet too, and their lie should be the protagonist's lie taken one step further. That is what makes an antagonist frightening rather than merely opposed.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ Want and need are different, and in tension.
- ☐ The ghost makes the lie reasonable rather than stupid.
- ☐ You know the page number where the lie breaks.

The Four Movements

Act structure with page targets attached. Pages are the only honest unit — one page is roughly one minute, and a second act that runs sixty-five pages is a second act that is going to be cut by someone less sympathetic than you.

THE RULE

Four movements, not three: the second act splits at the midpoint, and pretending it does not is why second acts sag. Each movement ends on a door closing behind the protagonist.

MOVE	WHAT IT DOES	PAGES	ENDS WHEN	YOUR PAGES
I	Setup → the door closes	1 – 25	The old life becomes impossible.	
II-A	Reaction → the midpoint	25 – 55	They respond, badly, and learn the rules.	
II-B	Action → all is lost	55 – 85	They act, and the lie costs them everything.	
III	Climax → the answer	85 – 105	The theme's question is answered in an image.	

AT A GLANCE

TOTAL TARGET _____ pages

INCITING INCIDENT page _____ (by 12)

MIDPOINT REVERSAL page _____ (dead centre)

ALL IS LOST page _____ (approx. 75%)

CLIMAX BEGINS page _____

WORKED EXAMPLE

The midpoint is not a bump — it is where the protagonist stops reacting and starts acting, or the reverse. If your midpoint is just an event, you have a hundred-page first act with an intermission.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ Each movement ends with an irreversible door closing.
- ☐ Page targets are written and the running total is tracked.
- ☐ The midpoint changes the protagonist's stance, not just the situation.

The Eight Sequences

Features are built from roughly eight sequences of ten to fifteen pages, each with its own small want and its own turn. This is the working unit — more tractable than an act, larger than a scene, and the level at which structural problems are actually fixable.

THE RULE

*Every sequence answers a dramatic question posed at its start, and the answer should be **yes but** or **no and** — never a flat yes.*

SEQ	DRAMATIC QUESTION	ANSWER (YES-BUT / NO-AND)	PAGES

A flat ‘yes’ ends the story early. A flat ‘no’ stops it dead. *Yes but* and *no and* are the only two answers that generate the next sequence.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If two adjacent sequences pose the same question, you have one sequence written twice. Merge them and take the pages back — you will want them at the end.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ Eight sequences, each with a question and a complicated answer.
- ☐ No two sequences ask the same question.
- ☐ Page counts sum to the target with fewer than ten pages of slack.

The Scene Ledger

Every scene, with the job it does. A scene that cannot state its job is the scene that gets cut in the edit, after you have paid to shoot or generate it — find it here, where deleting it costs one line.

THE RULE

*Every scene must **turn**: something is different at the end than at the start. A scene where nothing changes is exposition wearing a costume.*

AT A GLANCE

TOTAL SCENES _____

AVERAGE LENGTH _____ pages (1.5–2.5 is healthy)

SCENES WITH NO TURN _____ — this number should be zero

LONGEST SCENE page _____, _____ pages

WORKED EXAMPLE

Enter late, leave early. If the scene's turn happens on page two of three, the third page is a goodbye that the cut will delete anyway.

NOTES, FALSE STARTS, THINGS TO TRY

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ Every row has a turn written in it.
- ☐ No scene exists only to deliver information.
- ☐ Every scene either advances the want or tightens the lie.

Worksheet

A scene with an empty turn column is a scene the edit will delete. Find it here, where deleting it costs one line.

The Script Builder

Standard format, and what goes inside it. Format is not decoration — it is the reason a page equals a minute, and a script that ignores it announces an amateur before the first line is read.

THE RULE

Action in present tense, active voice, short paragraphs — three lines maximum. White space is pace: a dense page reads slow no matter what happens on it.

STANDARD FORMAT

INT. LIGHTHOUSE - LANTERN ROOM - NIGHT

Rain hammers the glass. MAREN, 60s, oilskin still dripping, cranks the mechanism by hand.

The beam swings out. Catches something in the water that should not be there.

MAREN
(not turning)
You're early.

She keeps cranking.

MEASUREMENTS

LEFT MARGIN	1.5"	CHARACTER NAME	3.5" from left, caps
RIGHT MARGIN	1.0"	PARENTHETICAL	3.0" from left
TOP / BOTTOM	1.0"	SCENE HEADING	caps, at left margin
DIALOGUE BLOCK	2.5" from left	PAGE NUMBERS	top right, from page 2

AT A GLANCE

FONT	Courier 12pt — non-negotiable
PAGE =	approx. 1 minute of screen time
ACTION PARAGRAPHS	1–3 lines
DIALOGUE BLOCKS	rarely over 4 lines

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ No camera directions unless you are also directing it.
- ☐ No unfilmable interiority — nothing the camera cannot see.
- ☐ Character names in dialogue are used sparingly; real people rarely say them.

The Dialogue Pass

A dedicated pass, done after the structure holds, never during. Dialogue written while the structure is still moving is dialogue you will delete.

THE RULE

*Characters should **not** say what they mean. The gap between what is said and what is wanted is where the audience does its work — and an audience doing work is an audience paying attention.*

FILL THIS IN

WHO SPEAKS IN SHORT SENTENCES, WHO RUNS LONG

WHAT EACH CHARACTER NEVER SAYS

THE LINE YOU WOULD CUT LAST

AT A GLANCE

NAME-BLIND TEST cover the names — can you tell who is speaking?

ON-THE-NOSE COUNT lines that state the theme aloud: ____ (aim: 0)

LONGEST SPEECH page ____ — can it be halved?

WORKED EXAMPLE

Run the name-blind test on ten random pages. If the answer is no, you have one character with several faces, and the fix is on Sheet 11, not here.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ The name-blind test passes on a random sample.
- ☐ Nobody states the theme out loud.
- ☐ Every scene's most important line is the one nobody says.

The Revision Passes

Revise in named passes, one concern at a time. Trying to fix structure, voice and prose simultaneously is how drafts get worse while getting longer.

THE RULE

One pass, one concern. Finish the pass before starting the next, and never fix a line during a structure pass — write it down and keep going.

RUN IN ORDER · TICK WHEN COMPLETE

- | | |
|----------------------|--|
| 1 · STRUCTURE | Does every sequence turn? Cut or merge. Do not touch a single line of dialogue. |
| 2 · CHARACTER | Does each arc break its lie on the page you planned? Fix the ghost if not. |
| 3 · SCENE | Enter late, leave early. Delete first and last lines of every scene, restore only what you miss. |
| 4 · DIALOGUE | Name-blind test. Cut every line that states the theme. |
| 5 · ACTION | Present tense, active voice, three lines maximum. Reclaim white space. |
| 6 · POLISH | Typos, formatting, page count. Read it aloud, start to finish, in one sitting. |

AT A GLANCE

DRAFT NUMBER _____

DATE STARTED / FINISHED _____ / _____

PAGES CUT THIS DRAFT _____

RULE every draft should get shorter

WORKED EXAMPLE

If a draft comes back longer, you added rather than revised. The exception is a first revision of a skeletal draft — after that, down is the direction.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ Each pass was run to completion before the next began.
- ☐ The page count went down.
- ☐ Someone who has not read a previous draft has now read this one.

The Production Bible

What the script implies but does not state: cast, locations, continuity, and — for a generated feature — the identity locks from Sheet 04 replicated for every character who appears more than once.

THE RULE

For generated features, this sheet is the whole ballgame. A feature is fifty to a hundred times more generation than a short, which means fifty to a hundred times more opportunity for a face to drift.

FILL THIS IN

LOCATIONS, AND WHAT EACH ONE MEANS

CONTINUITY RISKS — WHAT WILL DRIFT FIRST

AT A GLANCE

SPEAKING ROLES

LOCATIONS

IDENTITY LOCKS WRITTEN

 /

 characters

REFERENCE SETS STORED AT

ESTIMATED GENERATIONS

CREDIT BUDGET

WORKED EXAMPLE

Rank your continuity risks before you start, then generate the riskiest sequence first — not the easiest. You want to discover an unsolvable identity problem on day three, not day forty.

DO NOT STOP DOWN FURTHER UNTIL

- ☐ Every recurring character has an identity lock and a reference set.
- ☐ The riskiest sequence is scheduled first, not last.
- ☐ The credit budget has a number in it, and a reserve.

The two running sheets

These are not stops. They run alongside every sheet, from the first to the last.

THE DRIFT LOG

Every time a generated element fails to match its lock, log it. The pattern in this column tells you what to hide, what to re-frame, and what to stop attempting — and it is the single most useful document you will own by the end of production.

SHOT	WHAT DRIFTED	AGAINST WHICH LOCK	FIX APPLIED	COST

THE COMPLIANCE GATE

Run before every publication, not once at the end. A disqualified film is worth zero regardless of its quality, which makes this the highest-leverage checklist in the handbook and the one most likely to be skipped.

- ☐ No copyrighted characters, IP, or brand logos in any frame.
- ☐ No licensed music. Original composition or royalty-free only, licence held and filed.
- ☐ No NSFW content.
- ☐ No political statement — in the film, the title, or the caption.
- ☐ No religious statement — same three places.
- ☐ Runtime clears the floor, measured on the delivered file.
- ☐ Required watermark present on the delivered file.
- ☐ Prompts and generation history published where required.
- ☐ Team size, ages, and account status all within the rules.

None of the films worth studying won on render quality. Every one of them won on a decision — and every decision in this handbook is one you make before the machine gets a vote.